TOWN OF THUNDERBOLT
REGULAR MONTHLY MEETING
WEDNESDAY, JUNE 5, 2024
6:00 PM

AGENDA HEARING

Public has five minutes per person to ask questions or comment on any agenda item.
Mayor Williams opened the public hearing up at 6 pm.

Beth Goette, 3006 Leonard St., asked for an explanation of the Owner-Occupied Amendment to the STR Ordinance. Attorney Barrow explained the change to Ms. Goette. Council Member Crenshaw stated the Town could require proof such as a Homestead Exemption to prove owner resides on the property.

Council Member Crenshaw stated the Town should require signage with a list of contact numbers, even if it is 9-1-1 listed. Attorney Barrow stated there was a big debate regarding signage and Council decided on the Ordinance as it is currently written. Council Member Drohan stated the sign issue was regarding size of signage.

Beth Goette stated a Homestead Exemption is for primary residence. Attorney Barrow stated that is just one factor. Council Member Barbaree stated Stephens-Day Exemption is another.

Council Member Crenshaw commented that Tybee is trying to pull back on the number of STRs allowed.

Mayor Williams closed the public comment at 6:29 pm.

REGULAR MEETING

1. **Call to order -** Mayor Williams called the meeting to order at 6:30 pm.

2. **Roll Call by Presiding Officer with Invocation, followed by the Pledge of Allegiance**

   In Attendance is Mayor Dana Williams and Council Members: Larry Ward, Bethany Skipper-Greer, Edward Drohan, James Lavin, and Brooks Barbaree. Staff in attendance: Police Chief, Sean Clayton, Police Lieutenant, Brandon Runyon; Fire Chief, Andrew Bateman; Public Works representative, Ben Oliver; Town Attorney, Charlie Barrow; Accounts Payable Manager, Katina Spaulding; Utility Clerk, Renee Holmes; Town Clerk/Zoning Administrator, Matthew Walker.

3. **Approval of Amended Meeting Agenda (moving Consent Agenda items C, D, and F to discussion agenda)**

   Mayor Williams asked for a motion to approve the amended agenda. **Council Member Ward made the motion to approve with a second by Council Member Crenshaw. The motion passed unanimously.**

4. **Approval of Minutes from Previous Meeting**:

Minutes of May 8, 2024

Mayor Williams asked for a motion to approve the meeting minutes of May 8, 2024. **Council Member Ward made the motion to approve with meeting minutes May 8, 2024. Council Member Crenshaw provided the second. The motions passed unanimously.**

5. **Presentation:**

a) William Gettis with Savannah Interagency Diversity Council presented Mayor Williams with a plaque of appreciation for attending and being a part of the Traffick Jam to fight against human trafficking.

b) Mayor Williams read the "Know Local-Go Local" business spotlight for July 2024. The businesses recognized in July are: Terracon, Victory Drive Self Storage, Jones Street Productions, and Erica Davis Lowcountry.

6. **Finance Report:**

There was no Financial Report due to the council meeting being moved to an earlier date in June.

7. **Consent Agenda:**

a) Approval of Budget amendment for 2023

Shannon Brett of HBBB explained the need for the budget amendment.

b) Approval of ARPA Fund budget amendment and Resolution

Shannon Brett of HBBB explained ARPA to Council Member Lavin.

c) First Reading of STR Ordinance Amendment
Re: Definition of "Owner-Occupied"

d) First Reading of Fence Ordinance Amendment

Council Member Lavin stated he read the amendment and questioned why it was being changed. Council Member Drohan stated the fence application from a few months ago led to this discussion. Originally, the ordinance was written for the standard 60' x 100' lot with 25' setbacks. There are non-traditional lots along Bonaventure Road and the Amendment also considers the character of the neighborhood.

A motion was made by Council Member Ward to approve all items of the amended consent agenda. Council Member Crenshaw provided the second. The motion passed unanimously.

8. **Discussion Agenda:**

a) Consideration to approve CORE MPO Memorandum of Understanding

Council Member Drohan stated his problem is there is minimal impact on Thunderbolt. He has an issue paying what isn't being impacted. Council Member Drohan stated there has been a massive increase in traffic and the heavy intersections of Shell Rd. and Sunset Blvd. Both start in Thunderbolt and goes to Savannah. There is a need for controlled intersections and the MPO should help us with regional traffic growth. Council Member Ward stated 2 synchronized lights would save the problem at Shell Rd.

A motion was made by Council Member Drohan to approve CORE MPO Memorandum of Understanding. Council Member Ward provided the second. The motion passed unanimously.

b) Second Reading and consideration to approve Ordinance to Amend Zoning Map

Council Member Drohan stated the Shell Road corridor is underused and undertaxed, mostly bought at tax sales. He stated the owner of MBS Properties has good ideas. Council Member Drohan feels the whole zone needs to be looked at by Planning and Zoning in regards to the comp plan. He is open to other property owners coming forward for zoning.

Council Member Lavin asked how it impacted the area and other property owners. Council Member Ward suggested more information regarding the position of other residents in the area and the study completed by Symbiocity, similar to what the Town did for the River Drive District and the Victory Drive District.

A motion was made by Council Member Drohan to approve Ordinance to Amend Zoning Map and request study of impact to the Shell Road corridor. Council Member Ward provided the second. The motion passed unanimously.

c) Second Reading and Consideration to Approve STR Ordinance Amendment
Re: Change in ownership

A motion was made by Council Member Ward to approve STR Ordinance Amendment regarding Change in Ownership. Council Member Drohan provided the second. The motion passed unanimously.

9. **Department Report** – Written Reports Submitted

by: **Police / Municipal Court / Neighborhood Watch – Sean Clayton, Chief of Police**
Chief Clayton had nothing to add to his report. Council Member Lavin asked about the speed cameras in Town. Chief Clayton explained the Sunset Blvd camera is a 65/35 split and the Shell Rd camera is a 35/65 split. Chief Clayton added the speed indicators are up and running. The Flock cameras have also been productive and helpful. Two stolen vehicles were located, a felony arrest was made, and a warrant service was conducted due to the help of the Flock cameras.

Fire –Fire Chief, Andrew Bateman
Chief Bateman had nothing to add to his report. Chief Bateman stated the FD radios should be shipped within 2 weeks.

Public Works Department – Ben Oliver, Public Works
Ben Oliver stated that due to the earlier date of the June 2024 meeting, a report is not available.

Town Clerk – Matthew Walker, Town Clerk
Clerk Walker had nothing further to add to his report.

10. **Legal Report** – Town Attorney, Charlie Barrow

Nothing to report or discuss

11. **Mayor and Council –**

Mayor Williams thanked Clerk Walker and also congratulated him on his upcoming wedding.

12. **Thunderbolt Museum**

Anna Maria Thomas discussed the Flea Markets will start back in September. The museum is taking donations for items in the museum store.

13. **Executive Session-**

Council Member Ward made a motion at 7:25 pm to leave regular session to enter executive session to discuss Personnel, Property, or Litigation. Council Member Crenshaw seconded. The motion passed unanimously.

Council Member Ward made a motion at 8:15 pm to leave executive session to return to regular session. Council Member Drohan seconded. The motion passed unanimously.

Council Member Ward made a motion to make Matthew Walker the Interim Town Administrator. Council Member Crenshaw provided the second. The motion passed unanimously.

Mayor Williams asked for a motion to adjourn the meeting. **Council Member Skipper-Greer made the motion with a second from Council Member Crenshaw. The motion passed unanimously.**

14. **Adjournment:**

The meeting adjourned at 8:16 pm.

Dana Williams, Mayor

Matthew D. Walker, Town Clerk

AFFIDAVIT

Personally appeared before the undersigned attesting officer, duly authorized to administer oaths, **Mayor, Dana Williams,** who, after being duly sworn, deposes and on oath states the following:

(1) I was the presiding officer of a meeting of the **Town of Thunderbolt** City Council held on the **5th** day **of June, 2024.**

(2) That it is my understanding that O.C.G.A. 50-14-4 (b) provides as follows:

> *When any meeting of an agency is closed to the public pursuant to subsection (a) of this Code Section the chairperson or other person presiding over such meeting shall execute and file with the official minutes of the meeting a notarized affidavit stating under oath that the subject matter of the meeting or the closed portion thereof was devoted to matters within the exceptions provided by law and identifying the specific relevant exception.*

(3) The subject matter of the closed meeting or closed portion of the meeting held on the **5th** day of **June, 2024** which was closed for the purpose of discussing Real Estate, *Personnel and/or Legal* Matters was devoted to matters within those exceptions as provided by law.

(4) This affidavit is being executed for the purpose of complying with the mandate of O.C.G.A. 50-14-4 (b) that such an affidavit be executed.

This **5th** day of **June, 2024.**

Mayor, Dana Williams

Sworn to and subscribed before me
this 5th day of **June, 2024.**
Notary Public

Council Members

SIGN IN SHEET

MEETING: Council Meeting **MEETING DATE:** June 26, 2024

NAME:	ADDRESS:
SEAN COMPTON	BANNON DR

TOWN OF THUNDERBOLT
SPECIAL CALLED COUNCIL MEETING
WEDNESDAY, JUNE 26, 2024
6:30 PM

MILLAGE PUBLIC HEARING

Public has five minutes per person to ask questions or comment on any agenda item.
Mayor Williams opened the public hearing up at 6:30 pm.

Sean Compton, Leslie Lunney, and Stella Lavin were in attendance. No questions were asked.

Mayor Williams closed the public hearing at 6:35 pm.

REGULAR MEETING

1. **Call to order -** Mayor Williams called the meeting to order at 6:35 pm.

2. **Roll Call by Presiding Officer with Invocation, followed by the Pledge of Allegiance**

   In Attendance is Mayor Dana Williams and Council Members: Larry Ward, Bethany Skipper-Greer, Edward Drohan, James Lavin, and Dave Crenshaw. Staff in attendance: Public Works Director, Oscar Crosby; Town Attorney, Charlie Barrow; and Interim Town Administrator/Town Clerk/Zoning Administrator, Matthew Walker.

3. **Approval of Meeting Agenda**

   Mayor Williams asked for a motion to approve the agenda. **Council Member Ward made the motion to approve with a second by Council Member Crenshaw. The motion passed unanimously.**

4. **Consent Agenda:**

   a) Approval of FY2023 Hotel Motel/STR Budget Amendment

   b) Approval of the millage rate

   c) Consideration to Approve purchase of Downing Street Lift Station Pump

   A motion was made by Council Member Drohan to approve all items on the consent agenda. Council Member Ward provided the second. The motion passed unanimously.

Mayor Williams asked for a motion to adjourn the meeting. **Council Member Ward made the motion with a second from Council Member Skipper-Greer. The motion passed unanimously.**

5. **Adjournment:**

The meeting adjourned at 6:52 pm.

Dana Williams, Mayor

Matthew D. Walker, Town Clerk

SIGN IN SHEET

MEETING: BZA and Council Meetings **MEETING DATE:** June 5, 2024

NAME:	ADDRESS:
Beth Grotte	3006 Leonard St Thunderbolt GA
Laura Hayes	2801 Hayes ave
Paul Miller	4781 USHWY 80 E Thunderbolt
Brad Mack	3105 Harris St. Thunderbolt.
Dawn Williams	3110 Harris St Thunderbolt